

run. On the positive side, LCDs consume less power, but that should not be an issue since home computers hardly run long enough to show up in the electricity bill.

Q I am interested in buying 256 MB SD RAM-new or used. I have a Pentium III 64 MB SDRAM, 1 GHz processor. What is the market price for both options?

Dipen

A You should never compromise on a component like memory modules. Going in for used RAM has many pitfalls although the deal might look good. Used RAM does not carry warranty, and if you are going to buy used RAM, buy it from a trusted source only. The new 256 SD RAM would cost you somewhere around Rs 1,950. Before you buy, though, make sure you point out to the dealer that you are using a Pentium III and not a Pentium 4 processor.

Q I recently upgraded my PC to an AMD64, and my older power supply cannot cope with the processor's power demands. As a result, my system does not boot when I connect an additional hard drive or an optical drive. Can you suggest a power supply that offers decent performance at an affordable price?

Rohit Kumar

A Before buying a power supply, take note of the upgrade path you will follow. If you are a gamer, then at some point, you will invest in a high-end graphics card. Most next-generation graphics cards require external power, which is drawn from the system SMPS. Drives will also be a part of your future upgrade. It is advisable to make the power supply as robust as possible for your future demands.

For the AMD64 motherboard, you will require a 350W power supply at the least, but I suggest you invest in a 400W. You need to be careful, as the market offers a variety of 400W units, not all of which are truly rated at 400. The SL range from Antec is good value for money, and you can get a SL400 for Rs 2,450 with a three-year